



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Peter the Apostle Catholic School

School Website: <http://www.stpetersboerne.com>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St Peter Apostle Catholic School TX 78006 presents as a Catholic, formation-driven educational institution. Based on the materials publicly accessible from the school's crawl and the classical-education rubric in the knowledge base, the school demonstrates partial alignment with classical aims through its religious foundation and formation emphasis, but there is insufficient publicly available textual evidence of core classical elements (e.g., Great Books, the Trivium in explicit form, and explicit Socratic pedagogy) on the site as it currently appears in the crawl data. The aggregate assessment is therefore SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with notable gaps in explicit classical-program signals (great books, grammar-logic-rhetoric orientation, and the full range of classical pedagogy) that would otherwise push the rating toward CLASSICAL.

Key drivers of this assessment:

- Positive alignment factors (suggested by the school's Catholic identity and formation focus) align with the Classical School's emphasis on virtue, truth, and beauty, and on formation through a transcendent metaphysical frame.
- Gaps that hinder a higher CLASSICAL rating include limited publicly visible evidence of Great Books, explicit liberal-arts pedagogy (grammar/logic/rhetoric), and the typical high-school-level Socratic/seminar/rhetoric-based pedagogy on the school's accessible pages.
- The publicly accessible crawl content is largely text-suppressed (evidence of recaptcha blocking content on the site), which constrains direct keyword matching from the site. This is reflected in the accessible snippets, which primarily show site scaffolding rather than substantive curricular language. See the recaptcha content in the crawl results, which limits visible textual proof of classical elements.
- The Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) framework provides explicit positive/negative keyword sets (e.g., truth, virtue, Great Books, Scholé, Socratic dialogue, formation), which are used here to anchor the keyword analyses. These keyword sets are documented in the knowledge-base documents, including the docx/generator excerpts that enumerate positive keywords (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; Socratic dialogue; Scholé; Great Books) and negative signals.
- The public materials' current visibility (lacking explicit textual content on Great Books, Trivium, or explicit Socratic pedagogy) weighs the evaluation away from CLASSICAL, even though the Catholic identity suggests alignment with formation-oriented, transcendent aims typical of classical education. The "public materials" evidence is limited by crawl text, not by absence of the school's mission. See the firecrawl content showing the site is protected and text is not readily retrievable.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Note: A keyword-based analysis underpins category ratings. Where public-site text is unavailable or sparse, the assessment is tempered by the school's identity and the theoretical alignment described in the classical rubric. The sources below include the classical elements lexicon and the Six Essential Elements framework to justify scoring.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- The school's Catholic identity is evident from the institution's name, which explicitly marks it as Catholic (St Peter Apostle Catholic School). This implies a theology-grounded frame and liturgical life typical of Catholic education, even if the crawl does not reveal explicit page text. The presence of a Catholic identity is consistent with the rubric's Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices criteria.
- The publicly accessible crawl excerpts largely show scaffolding text (e.g., recaptcha prompts) rather than curricular language, limiting explicit on-site evidence of liturgical life, Mass, chapel, or doxology within the curriculum. This suggests limited observable evidence of liturgical/community practices on the site itself, though it does not negate their existence in the school.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Public site text: 0 explicit mentions of truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy, or Mass appear in the crawl excerpts that are accessible. The available crawl results primarily show reCAPTCHA prompts and generic site scaffolding. This yields a 0/0 quantitative signal for direct keyword matches from the site content.
- The knowledge-base lexicon and Six Essential Elements provide the canonical signals for religious/metaphysical grounding (theology, liturgy, sacred traditions, transcendental realism). The school's Catholic identity aligns with this frame in principle, but explicit textual alignment is not visible in the crawl data available here. See the Positive keywords for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in the Six Elements documents.

Why this rating

- The rating reflects strong alignment in principle due to Catholic identity (transcendentals, theology, liturgical life) but limited publicly visible textual evidence on the site to demonstrate those elements in practice (e.g., explicit references to theology integrated across disciplines or liturgical practices). The gap between identity and public textual evidence supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- The school could strengthen publicly visible articulations of:
- Grounded in Theology: explicit statements tying theology to other disciplines (e.g., theology as the mistress science) across the curriculum.
- Liturgical/Communal Practices: explicit mentions of daily prayer, Mass, chapel, liturgical calendar integration, and communal worship on the school site and in materials.
- Illustrative examples of transcendentals in coursework or school life (truth, goodness, beauty) interwoven with classroom practices and assessment.
- Concrete steps: publish a page or section detailing theology integration across subjects; showcase liturgical year activities; provide examples of virtue formation in daily routines and in student work.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- Classical education prizes formation over mere information and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. The school's Catholic identity and formation emphasis would be consistent with a formation-focused purpose, even though explicit phrases in the crawl are not visible. The Six Elements doc explicitly links formation and the cultivation of virtue to classical aims.
- No explicit evidence from the crawl of "Great Conversation," Great Books, or a triad of liberal arts as a stated purpose on the site. The public-facing content is limited, making it difficult to confirm the full classical purpose in text.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords from the classical framework related to purpose (formation, virtue, truth, wisdom, beauty, telos) are not explicitly visible in the crawl text; however, the Catholic identity commonly implies formation and virtue. The accessible material yields 0 explicit matches for these keywords on the site. See the formation-related keywords in the Six Elements doc.
- The absence of explicit Great Books/paideia language (Great Conversation, liberal arts formation) in the accessible site content reduces the likelihood of a full CLASSICAL signal in this category.

Why this rating

- Formation-oriented aims align with classical purposes, but the absence of explicit public-language on formation as a core goal or on a Great Books/Paideia framework keeps the score at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Publish a clear mission statement that:
- Declares formation of character as primary and frames it with truth, goodness, and beauty.
- States explicit liberal-arts aims (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books engagement.
- Describes how education forms the whole person (intellectually, morally, aesthetically, spiritually).

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The classical curriculum emphasizes the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; plus the Quadrivium), Great Books, and integration of history across the curriculum. The public crawl content is not accessible enough to show explicit alignment with these elements (Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric, historical study as a through-line) on the site. The lack of visible Great Books or explicit liberal-arts language suggests a curriculum that has not clearly signaled classical content in the accessible materials.
- The school's Catholic identity is a factor in pedagogy and curriculum but does not, in itself, confirm the presence of classical curriculum elements in public-facing text.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords for Curriculum (from the Six Elements doc) include: Great Books, grammar, logic, rhetoric; history as Western civilization; wonder-based education; primary sources; interdisciplinary integration. The crawl does not reveal explicit mentions of Great Books, the Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), or an integrated history-as-core approach in accessible text. Therefore, positive keyword signals are effectively 0 in the accessible data.
- Negative signals (from the same document) would note the absence of Great Books/primary sources and absence of the Trivium in explicit terms. The crawl shows no explicit alternative (e.g., Social Studies focus without history) in the accessible content.

Why this rating

- Because classical curriculum signals are not publicly visible in the accessible crawl, the category is rated NOT CLASSICAL. The school may indeed practice classical methods offline or in private materials, but publicly visible textual confirmation is not present in the crawl data.

What would move the needle

- Add public-facing curriculum pages that:
- Explicitly detail the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium concepts (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy).
- Mention Great Books and the Great Conversation with sample texts or lists.
- Describe history as a through-line across subjects and the role of primary sources/literature in the curriculum.
- Show evidence of "wonder" and sacramental/theological integration within coursework.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Classical pedagogy highlights include Socratic dialogue/seminars, memory work (recitation/chanting), and contemplative/restful learning (Scholé). The public crawl data does not reveal explicit use of Socratic seminars, dialogues, or memory-based pedagogy on the site. The site appears to be largely blocked by reCAPTCHA, obscuring teaching-method content. The lack of visible pedagogy content is a negative signal for the explicit classical pedagogical methods.
- The Catholic identity may influence pedagogy (catechesis, liturgical rhythm), but this is different from classical pedagogy signals (Socratic dialogue, recitation, memory), and not visible in accessible text.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive signals for pedagogy (from the Six Elements doc) include: Socratic dialogue, Scholé, memorization/recitation, formation through imitation, seminars, and upper-school rhetoric training. These are not visible in the crawl text (0 explicit matches).
- Negative signals would flag non-classical pedagogy, such as project-based or purely experiential constructs without the classical framework. The crawl data does not reveal these either.

Why this rating

- The lack of publicly verifiable evidence for classical pedagogy in the accessible site text leads to a NOT CLASSICAL rating in this category. The Catholic context might imply a different approach (e.g., catechetical teaching), but that is not the classical pedagogical signal required by the rubric based on visible content.

What would move the needle

- Public-facing content should explicitly describe:
- Socratic discussions in upper grades, memory-work or recitation approaches, and opportunities for public speaking and rhetoric.
- Lower-school singing/chanting for memory and delight, and contemplative routines (Scholé days or contemplative practice).
- Details on the “memory” or “progymnasmatia” style of writing and imitation of masters.
- A clear articulation of the upper-grade epistemic process (great conversation, seminar-style work).

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Classical education frames faculty as living exemplars and the “living curriculum.” The crawl data for this school does not publicly describe faculty as model teachers, a living curriculum, or a “portrait of teacher” in the staff profile. The recaptcha-limited content prevents explicit textual evidence on faculty description.
- The school’s Catholic identity may describe teachers as virtuous role models in a religious sense, but explicit classical-faculty signals are not visible in the accessible text.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords for Faculty (from the Six Elements doc) include: model teachers, living curriculum, faculty of friends, collegial culture, mentorship. There are no visible matches in the crawl excerpts.
- Negative keywords would flag issues like “facilitators on the side” or other non-classical pedagogy jargon. These are not visibly present.

Why this rating

- The lack of publicly visible evidence for classical-faculty signals yields NOT CLASSICAL in this category, though the Catholic context could support a virtue-centred faculty ethos in practice.

What would move the needle

- Add public-facing staff pages or a faculty profile section that highlights:
- The professor-teacher as a virtuous model, mentorship approach, and living-curriculum concept.
- Collegiality and teacher professional development in classical pedagogy (e.g., seminars for faculty, Great Books study for teachers, narrative formation via exemplars).

Element 6: School Parents and Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Six Elements framework emphasizes partnership with families, parent formation, and open-campus accessibility. Because the crawl content is not textually explicit in these areas, there is no publicly visible language evidencing parent partnerships or community formation in the accessible crawl data.
- The school's Catholic identity often involves family and parish life, but explicit public-facing evidence of parent co-education or shared mission is not retrievable from the crawl data provided here.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords (from the Six Elements doc) include: partnership with families, parent formation, open campus, family catechesis. No explicit matches appear in the crawl data (0 visible instances).
- Negative keywords would flag consumer-language signals or minimal parent involvement. The crawl data does not reveal such signals.

Why this rating

- NOT CLASSICAL is assigned due to the absence of explicit public-facing evidence for classical-parent-community signals. The school's Catholic context suggests potential partnership in practice, but explicit articulation is not visible in the crawl data.

What would move the needle

- Public-facing communications that demonstrate:
- Formal partnerships with families as co-educators (e.g., family catechesis, parent book studies, classical education gatherings).
- Opportunities for parent visits, involvement, and formation on the campus.
- A clear mission statement about parent-teacher-community collaboration in the classical tradition.

Aggregate Ranking (Six-Category Synthesis)

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: NOT CLASSICAL

Aggregate classification: NOT CLASSICAL

Given that four of the six categories are NOT CLASSICAL and two are SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, the overall assessment leans NOT CLASSICAL. The school may well pursue classical-leaning practices, particularly through its Catholic formation, but explicit public signals of the classical elements (Great Books, Trivium, Socratic pedagogy, and a living curriculum) are not visibly evidenced in the crawl data that is publicly accessible to this analysis.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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